

Enduring University: Unfinished, Yet Alive

A Journey of Purpose, Renewal, and Courage

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ABSTRACT

This essay is the work of a question that has never quite let go: what does it take for a university not merely to survive but to remain faithful to its abiding purpose—across generations of change, upheaval, and renewal? That question has followed six decades of work as scholar, leader, and advisor—across universities and industry, several continents and many institutions. One truth has held across institutions that have outlasted empires: a university endures not because it possesses the truth, but because it renews the human capacities that sustain the search for it. Three capacities—curiosity, creativity, and courage, the 3Cs—give that culture its inner life. Keeping all three true to their purpose is the work of conscience: not a fourth capacity, but the compass the other three depend on. Three Parts carry the argument forward: Part I asks what makes a university truly excellent; Part II examines how purpose becomes institutional life through leadership, trust, and stewardship; Part III turns to culture—deeper than strategy or structure—as the architecture through which renewal takes root across generations. The essay draws on both Eastern and Western traditions, offered at a moment when that combination feels less like personal inheritance and more like necessity.

Keywords: university leadership · higher education · institutional renewal · curiosity, creativity, courage · stewardship · academic culture · NUS

Preface: Reflections Across Time and Seasons

This essay is the work of a long journey—across universities and industry, six decades and several continents—in which the question of what a university is truly for has never quite let go. That span includes a decade in the private sector as a research leader in R&D and startups, where the pressures of innovation and enterprise sharpened instincts that no campus alone could have forged, before the longer return to academic life: from the National University of Singapore to King Abdullah University of Science and Technology, through advisory work spanning corporations and research institutes worldwide, and in service to three Presidents of the University of the Chinese Academy of Sciences.

From those years, I have drawn on both Eastern and Western traditions—carrying from the West a sense of agency and accountability, and from the East a longer civilizational view: patient in cultivation, and rooted in the quiet knowing that what is planted with care will find its season. That journey is unfinished—as any honest account of the enduring university must be. It is offered in that spirit: exploratory, alive, and open to what the next season may bring.

Six decades across universities and industry have made one truth inescapable: how deeply institutional character is shaped by mission. While corporations pursue market value, universities bear a different kind of trust—one rooted in learning, service, and stewardship. That trust is now being tested in an era of turbulence, as technological disruption and shifting political currents press upon institutions whose purposes were formed in quieter times. What a university needs to navigate such a moment is not strategy alone, but renewal—rooted in purpose, guided by hard-won judgment, and sustained by the courage to act amid uncertainty. Renewal, rightly understood, is not reinvention but evolution with continuity—holding fast to what is essential and remaining answerable to what the moment requires.

Yet the deeper test of renewal is not external. A university's capacity for renewal depends on something closer to home: the collegial trust that binds mission to daily practice from within. In this era, that trust ranks among the most quietly eroded of institutional assets—felt most sharply in its absence. The remedy, though, is nearer than it may appear. The university's people—many drawn to academic life not for security or status, but for the chance to pursue what genuinely matters to them—are, in themselves, the resource that institutional renewal most needs. When their aspirations align with mission, something more than efficiency is achieved: their work acquires deeper meaning, and the institution draws its deepest strength from the devotion of those who believe in what the university is for.

That commitment—and what it demands of leadership—crystallized in a university address: “A Good University Teaches; A Great University Transforms.” The conviction endures. But the decades of practice have tempered that conviction with a harder recognition: that without inner renewal, transformation risks becoming performance rather than permanence. This inward resolve—quietly rooted, steadily renewed—is what gives transformation its lasting force.

That resolve draws on three capacities—curiosity, creativity, and courage—easier to name than to cultivate, and harder still to keep alive across the long arc of an institution. Orienting all three is conscience: not a fourth capacity, but the inner compass that keeps the other three true to their purpose. They are not givens. Each must be tended—against the pressures of conformity, the fatigue of routine, and the slow drift toward the merely expedient.

It is the journey of keeping those capacities alive—in each generation, across every season of change—that this essay traces: not as a finished achievement to be defended, but as a continuing endeavor to be lived, carried forward by those willing to tend what they inherited—and to begin what they may not complete.

PART I

Purpose: Wellspring of Enduring Excellence

The enduring university is not a finished institution, but a continuing human journey—sustained across generations by purpose, renewal, and courage. It endures not because it possesses the truth, but because it renews the human capacities that keep the search for truth alive.

Its endurance depends on a culture shaped by inquiry, scholarship, and service—one in which purpose and values are woven into daily life, excellence is measured by public trust, and horizons remain open to wonder and humility. That openness—deepened by curiosity, creativity, and courage—is the ground of enduring excellence.

What, then, makes a university truly excellent—worthy, in time, of being called “great”? The question is easier asked than answered. Rankings and research output matter, but they are instruments, not the measure of excellence. Greatness, in this deeper sense, lies in excellence in service of purpose: creating knowledge, developing human potential, and serving society in ways that earn and renew public trust over time. Such excellence is aligned with purpose, guided by values, and answerable to those it serves—a standard no ranking was designed to capture, and none ever will.

Purpose so understood—the university’s reason for being—sets the horizon of lasting significance. It orients mission, sustains values, and gives direction to the university’s work across time. Largely unseen yet quietly foundational, it is the source from which inquiry, learning, and the cultivation of human potential draw their nourishment and direction—and from which the capacities that carry the university forward take root and grow.

Purpose finds expression in three movements. Inwardly, mission gives purpose direction, while values, enduring yet responsive, provide ethical grounding; together, they carry purpose into judgment, decision, and daily practice. Upward, vision clarifies the horizon—not replacing purpose but renewing and enlarging it, aligning the university’s work with what it seeks to become. Outwardly, calling carries purpose into the civic realm: serving society, widening opportunity, and stewarding the public good. Through this outward reach—answerable to the communities the university exists to serve—purpose becomes more than institutional conviction; it becomes public trust.

Enduring excellence, then, is not declared but practiced—expressed through inquiry, learning, and service, and tested against the commitments that give it meaning. What is needed now is not the defense of the familiar, but the renewal of excellence: an excellence that meets what this era asks of the university without surrendering what must endure.

That renewal begins within. At its deepest, it is a renewal of the human capacities the university exists to cultivate. Excellence, so understood, is not a fixed standard but a living commitment—one that deepens through practice, guided by judgment that reads context, weighs consequences, and asks not merely whether metrics are met, but whether the university is truly advancing inquiry, developing human potential, and strengthening the public good. Metrics matter—but only insofar as they illuminate what truly counts. Rigor and standards are upheld in service of the mission—never permitted to substitute for it. That evolution,

guided by purpose, is not a concession. It is how purpose stays alive.

Purpose remains alive only when it is lived, not merely declared. Renewal is therefore not optional; it is the ground on which purpose endures—and the work to which the university must continually return.

The Ethos of Renewal: Cultivated from Within

Renewal is the university's continuing response to changing times—not a reinvention of what it is, but a return to what it has always been called to do: faithful to purpose, attentive to what shifts, and anchored in the values that endure. A university sustains excellence not by retreating from change, but by holding fast to its mission while embracing what each new moment asks of it.

What drives renewal is less strategy or structure than ethos—the inner conviction that shapes how a university thinks, works, and acts. That conviction cannot be mandated or planned; it must be cultivated. The 3Cs—curiosity, creativity, and courage—are the capacities from which that ethos grows: not directives imposed from above, but dispositions nurtured from within. Each carries its own distinctive force; together, they give renewal coherence and depth.

Culture is the ground in which the 3Cs take root and spread—expressed in the ways people teach, collaborate, decide, and respond to change. Sustained through shared endeavor and the quiet accumulation of practice, culture carries the 3Cs from aspiration to lived reality and, over time, into heritage—turning purpose into practice and practice into the institution's way of being.

Curiosity: Oxygen for the Mind

Curiosity is oxygen for the mind—fueling inquiry, sparking exploration, and deepening understanding. It compels us to ask questions, challenge assumptions, and seek insight beyond the visible horizon—perceiving possibility where others see limits, and staying alert to what remains unthought. Yet it is also fragile: what comes naturally in childhood is not always what schooling protects—over-structured systems too easily trade open-ended inquiry for standardized outcomes, dulling the very curiosity such systems need to thrive.

Curiosity, once kindled, proves remarkably resilient. Richard Feynman called it “the pleasure of finding things out”; Albert Einstein declared that it “has its own reason for existing.” It is the beginning of genuine understanding, driving us to pursue not just what is, but what could be. It welcomes the unfamiliar, lingers where others move on, and uncovers insight where few think to look—gradually reshaping what we thought we knew. Curiosity keeps the human spirit awake—alive to what matters most.

That impulse—to question, to follow where questions lead—gives rise to exploration; exploration nurtures creativity; creativity opens new paths of inquiry. These three form a living cycle—at the heart of discovery in every field of human endeavor, and of renewal in the life of the university.

Creativity: Alchemy of Imagination

Creativity is the mind's alchemy—the essential antidote to inert ideas. In *The Aims of Education*, Alfred North Whitehead warns that education built on ideas passively received—never tested, applied, or thrown into fresh combinations—is not merely useless but harmful. It is creativity that supplies the remedy: breathing vitality into learning by forging unexpected combinations and distilling new possibilities from what others take as given.

Although often seen as innate, creativity is a capacity that can be cultivated—through inquiry, reflection, and environments that encourage play, experiment, and risk-taking. Across eras and traditions, figures as varied as Leonardo da Vinci bridging art and science, Zhuangzi dissolving the divide between knowing and being, Stravinsky remaking the grammar of music, and Steve Jobs marrying design and technology have each reimagined the world's limits rather than working within them—and in doing so, irrevocably extended the horizon of what humanity could imagine.

Yet creativity alone may remain suspended in imagination—brilliant yet unrealized. What distinguishes the vision that enters the world from the one that does not is not talent or circumstance. It is courage—the one capacity that cannot be nurtured from the outside or rewarded in advance, because it is the one that costs something.

Courage: Crucible of the Will

Courage is the crucible of the will—where conviction meets resistance, and what endures through that reckoning becomes real. Curiosity opens the question; creativity gives it form; courage determines whether it enters the world.

Courage differs from the other two capacities—not in sequence, but in kind. Curiosity can be kindled by wonder; creativity can be nurtured by collaboration and serendipity. Courage cannot be compelled or rewarded in advance. Circumstances may call it forth—crisis, the sight of suffering, conscience pressing from within. No external condition can complete it; the response must rise from within, and hold.

Of the three capacities, courage is the least celebrated in academic life—and the one this essay dwells on longest. The reason is telling: it is the only one that costs something. Curiosity and creativity are praised, resourced, and institutionally rewarded; courage, by contrast, is frequently invoked and rarely practiced—and that cost is seldom visible.

It lives in what was not compromised, what was not conceded, what held firm when the easier path was available: in the scholar who tells an inconvenient truth, the leader who declines a misaligned opportunity, and the institution that holds to its mission when the world offers it a different and more profitable one. Courage, in this light, is not a personal virtue grafted onto academic life. It is the condition under which purpose becomes practice and commitment becomes deed—thereby making renewal actual rather than ornamental. Without courage, curiosity and creativity, however bright, remain unrealized.

Conscience: Courage's Quiet Compass

Yet courage, without orientation, can distort as readily as it compels—masking willfulness as conviction, and rigidity as principle. In its raw form, courage is energy; what gives it direction is conscience.

Across traditions, the deepest counsel on courage is less about summoning it than about guiding it. Confucius cautioned that courage without righteousness invites disorder. Socrates linked courage to virtue formed through unflinching self-examination—not boldness alone, but boldness that has passed through the fire of honest questioning. Rumi urged us to heed the inner voice attuned to truth and meaning, especially when the ground shifts underfoot. These perspectives, separated by centuries and traditions, converge on a single insight: courage matures from impulse to virtue only when conscience steadies it—ensuring that what courage carries forward serves what is just, true, and faithful to purpose.

What the philosophical traditions call conscience, Aristotle named practical wisdom—*phronesis*: the cultivated capacity to judge well in particular circumstances, guided not by rule but by a formed sense of what genuinely matters. Conscience and *phronesis*, across traditions, name the same quiet orientation: the one that keeps courage true to its purpose.

Conscience, so understood, sharpens judgment, grounds reflection, and keeps action proportionate and purposeful. In institutional life, it keeps attention on what is consequential, resists the pull of distraction and expediency, and holds leadership faithful to mission and values—even when that requires difficult trade-offs or saying no to attractive but misaligned opportunities. Conscience is courage’s quiet compass: not the loudest voice in institutional life, but the truest.

The Duty to Act: Courage in Academic Life

Nowhere is that compass more tested—or its testing more consequential—than in academic life. In *Academic Duty* (1997), Donald Kennedy—who served as Stanford’s president for over a decade—frames the professor’s obligations under headings that reveal the full institutional demand of courage: “To Serve the University,” “To Tell the Truth,” “To Reach Beyond the Walls.” These are not merely professional obligations; together, they amount to a continuing demand for courage—the courage to speak plainly when silence is easier, to serve when recognition is unlikely, and to reach outward when insularity would be safer. Kennedy’s argument is institutional: universities cannot exercise intellectual leadership without those willing to bear these costs.

Courage Lived: Curie and Lee

Such obligations are easier named than lived—but some lives show what it means to live them. Marie Curie pressed forward undeterred—through barriers that were not only scientific but social, institutional, and deeply personal. Her discoveries of polonium and radium helped pave the way for life-saving advances such as radiotherapy; her refusal to patent radium—an ethical resolve that kept its benefits widely accessible—embodied a courage that reached beyond the laboratory.

If Curie exemplifies courage in the pursuit of knowledge, Lee Kong Chian offers its civic-minded counterpart. He built his wealth through foresight and enterprise, guided throughout by an abiding sense of

duty to society. Rather than concentrating private fortune, he risked much of it to found the Lee Foundation in pre-independence Singapore—establishing a philanthropic institution dedicated to education and societal renewal. His was the courage not of the dramatic gesture but of long commitment. Conviction his ground, humility his bearing, and reach his measure—his was duty carried steadily into deed.

What unites them—the lives of Curie and Lee, and the obligations Kennedy names—is a single truth: courage in its fullest form is neither impulsive nor loud, but measured and steadfast, willing to bear the cost that purpose sometimes demands.

Principled Tension: Inquiry, Will, and the Between

That tension—between the impulse to question and the imperative to act—has ancient roots. The Socratic spirit—relentless, probing, and inexhaustible—runs deep in the university’s identity. Yet left entirely to itself, it carries a latent risk—the slide toward hesitation, toward the endless deferral of action in pursuit of a certainty that never comes. Nietzsche offered the necessary counterpoint: it is not enough to ask *why*; one must also summon the will to decide, create, and act.

The 3Cs hold these forces in principled tension—and in doing so, give the university its deepest coherence. Curiosity honors the Socratic spirit, keeping inquiry open, searching, and honest. Creativity transforms what is not yet seen into what can be made. And courage carries ideas across that threshold—from the shelter of thought into the exposure of action, consequence, and accountability.

The Tree: Root to Canopy

The university’s deepest architecture resolves into a single image: a tree rooted in purpose, mission, and values—its trunk shaped by curiosity, creativity, and courage, its canopy bearing the fruits of the university’s public service: knowledge created, lives shaped, and public trust earned. Beneath the surface, the root system steadies the tree—with conscience as the living connector between roots and trunk, ensuring that these capacities grow true to what the institution is for. What endures is not built but grown—and unlike a machine, a tree cannot be assembled from parts, nor rushed into being. It grows from within, or not at all.

And from the canopy, seeds fall—unannounced—carrying purpose forward into seasons not yet visible and renewing the journey in each generation. What the tree cannot complete, it entrusts: not as unfinished failure, but as the living terms of continuity—the gift that each generation receives, extends, and passes on before its own work is done. This is the act of stewardship.

PART II

Stewardship: Leadership, Trust, and Courage

If purpose gives direction and awakens conviction, stewardship turns each into habit—and habit, over time, into the lived character of an institution. Yet that character is never self-sustaining; without the continual

renewal of coherence among mission, values, and everyday practice, it erodes from within. One truth has held across every institution where I have worked: what endures is less what a university achieves than how deeply it lives what it believes. That depth is made possible by leadership attuned to vision, steadfast in purpose, and rooted in trust—and renewed, from within, by the 3Cs.

Leadership, here, is less a matter of position than of attentive presence and steady engagement. Its strength lies in a clear, unifying vision: a guiding orientation—not a rigid blueprint—rooted in collegial traditions that safeguard academic freedom and shared governance. That presence, marked by listening, thoughtfulness, and the willingness to decide when deciding is hard, creates the conditions for faculty, staff, and students to explore and contribute—building the trust and coherence on which the institution depends.

Trust is the quiet foundation on which personal freedom and collective aspiration meet. Where trust is strong, diverse views are welcomed without losing direction, and individuality deepens rather than diminishes the whole. It is trust, more than any structure or policy, that holds all of this together—and that turns the university from an institution into a community.

The Mother Tree: Unity, Not Uniformity

The deepest unity is not organized. It is grown. Think of a mother tree—one of the ancient ones, its canopy broad, its roots deep, its reach far and wide. Beneath the surface, it sustains a network through which nourishment passes between trees, seedlings are tended, and what has been accumulated over a long life is shared across generations. The forest it anchors is a community—held together not by uniformity but by common roots and the slow gift of what each generation adds.

A university aspires to be what the mother tree embodies—not uniform in its parts, but unified in its purpose. And like the mother tree, it measures its life in centuries: Oxford has stood for nearly a thousand years, Bologna for longer still, each outlasting the empires and upheavals that sought to unmake them. What endured was not buildings or reputation, but the living network of purpose, trust, and accumulated wisdom.

Awakening: A Season of Becoming

A defining example was the launch of NUS Overseas Colleges (NOC) and NUS Enterprise—initiatives designed to foster entrepreneurial thinking, spur exploration, and build resilience in a rapidly changing world. Immersive internships within global startup ecosystems—from Silicon Valley to Stockholm to Shanghai—opened new horizons and gave students the footing to act in settings where little is certain. Students returned not only with startup experience or global exposure, but with sharpened instincts for inquiry, a tolerance for ambiguity, and the confidence to act before the path was fully clear.

While NOC placed students inside the world's startup ecosystems, the University Scholars Programme (USP) cultivated a different kind of depth—through ideas, dialogue, and the sustained intellectual community of a rigorous residential program at NUS. Two programs, one purpose.

Tenure Reform and the No-Walls Ethos

The NUS Tenure Reform reached deeper than program or structure—reshaping academic culture itself in ways that called for steady courage and resolve. It replaced a seniority-based model with one founded on merit and transparency: applicant-initiated, with parallel academic and administrative evaluations—a design rare in Asia at the time, and a direct challenge to the region’s prevailing rank-centric culture. What made it possible was trust—built through sustained dialogue, tested against long-held norms, and held through resistance.

Beneath these initiatives lay a single unifying aim: to reshape NUS’s culture toward open inquiry and collegial trust. At its heart was a “no-walls” ethos—the deliberate lowering of barriers between disciplines, institutions, and cultures. Its first public expression came in a 2002 welcome address: “no walls to talent, no walls to ideas, no walls around minds.” In time, more than 70% of undergraduates crossed borders. For a city-state with a citizen population of barely four million, this was not incidental but essential.

Trust: What Made It Possible

Across these initiatives—the overseas colleges, the scholars program, the tenure reform, the no-walls ethos—one condition made each of them possible and carried each of them forward: trust. Not trust assumed at the outset, but trust earned over time through transparency, consistency, and leadership willing to be held to its own stated commitments.

That belief—and what it made possible—is the deeper lesson of those years. Trust, once built, must be actively kept. The conditions that made renewal possible at NUS did not persist automatically—they were tended, season by season, by people willing to hold the institution to its own commitments.

Tending the Trust: Mission Against the Currents

Among the enduring currents that make stewardship demanding, two have long been familiar: the creep of bureaucracy and the pull of market logics. A third—more novel in form but no less consequential—has lately joined them.

AI carries real promise for the university: it can extend access to knowledge across barriers of geography and circumstance, free scholars from rote labor, and open new frontiers of inquiry. Yet promise and peril, here, are inseparable. By reshaping how knowledge is generated, transmitted, and evaluated, AI threatens to displace—gradually, without announcement—the very capacities the university exists to cultivate: wonder, the pleasure of discovery, and the slow formation of judgment that no algorithm can replicate.

Beneath these currents runs a deeper and older tension, one that no generation of stewards has fully resolved: how much of the world the university should serve, and how much it must stand apart to serve it truly. Clark Kerr observed that the campus and society were undergoing a reluctant but inexorable merger. Allan Bloom reversed the relation entirely. Both are right—and the tension between them is not a problem to be solved but a condition to be lived.

No other institution simultaneously holds academic freedom, multigenerational continuity, and the deliberate cultivation of curiosity, creativity, and courage as its primary purpose—shaping, cohort by cohort, how an entire society learns to question, imagine, and act with conscience. That combination, sustained across centuries and renewed in each generation, is the university’s most enduring contribution to the public good.

PART III

Culture: Wellspring of Enduring Character and Meaning

Culture—deeper than strategy or structure—shapes how people engage with ideas, one another, and the institution itself, imparting a unifying ethos of coherence, character, and direction—and, over time, of meaning. While strategy sets the course, culture makes it real and sustainable—turning purpose, values, and mission into lived practice where they take root, deepen, and endure.

In a 1994 *Foreign Affairs* conversation with Fareed Zakaria, titled “Culture Is Destiny,” Lee Kuan Yew—Singapore’s founding prime minister—argued that, more than politics or economics, culture ultimately shapes a community’s renewal and possibilities. What is true of societies is no less true of universities: culture is what ultimately shapes whether a university’s deepest possibilities are realized or quietly lost.

Yet culture without conscience is form without faith—observed but not believed, maintained but not lived.

Charles W. Eliot captured this more than a century ago: “A university, in any worthy sense of the term, must grow from seed... It cannot be run up, like a cotton-mill, in six months, to meet a quick demand.” His metaphor reminds us that great institutions are not built in haste but cultivated with care.

Social Architecture of Renewal

From this soil, the social architecture of renewal takes shape—at once organic and intentional, grounded in the rhythms of daily life yet shaped by shared purpose and collegial trust. At NUS, it was that dimension—lived in shared laboratories, in late-evening seminars, in the daily accumulation of small collegial acts—that carried renewal deeper than any single reform could reach.

That orientation—wonder at what remains unknown, humility about what can truly be known—is what culture cultivates at its deepest: the ground from which genuine inquiry grows. Culture, sustained well, does not answer the university’s deepest questions—it keeps them alive.

Meaning: Wonder, Humility, and Inquiry

Few have framed this quest more searchingly than Gauguin, whose great 1897 painting bears not one question but three: *Where Do We Come From? What Are We? Where Are We Going?* They are questions

that do not resolve—only open further.

“To myself, I am only a child playing on the seashore, every now and then finding a smoother pebble or a prettier shell than ordinary, while vast oceans of truth lie undiscovered before me.”

—Isaac Newton

That orientation—wonder, humility, and courage held together—is what the university carries into every season of change, and what each generation inherits as the ground from which its own work begins.

EPILOGUE

A Curious Mind, a Steady Heart, and a Light Step

If the university is to endure, it must endure not as a finished institution, but as a continuing human endeavor—renewed across generations by purpose, courage, and the willingness to begin again.

It is this formation of conscience, carried generation by generation, that gives endurance its truest meaning. Purpose sets direction; curiosity, creativity, and courage carry it forward; culture sustains all across time. Of the many institutions that serve the public good, the university occupies a singular place: it alone makes the cultivation of curiosity, creativity, and courage—under conditions of academic freedom—its primary purpose. Other institutions draw on these capacities; the university exists, above all, to renew them in the world.

Curiosity, creativity, and courage—and conscience—are not convictions I arrived at through learning and reflection alone. They are inner truths shaped across a lifetime—not destinations reached, but quiet companions: a steady presence through every season of change.

Among these companions, curiosity has often illuminated the way—sometimes with a spirit of adventure, and at other times with a quieter attentiveness. It was curiosity in this quieter register that made me most receptive to my Buddhist mother’s reflective wisdom—her reminder not to hold too tightly to anything: things or feelings, gains or losses. She taught me that life is about traveling light—letting go of what weighs us down and lifting our gaze beyond the immediate to the horizon. Though she has been gone for many years now, her gentle counsel still shapes how I seek clarity, let go, and live by what matters—humility, humanity, and humor—essentials light enough to travel with, steady enough to trust.

What we set in motion today becomes part of a journey still unfolding—and what is truly worth doing, as Reinhold Niebuhr reminded us, need not be completed in our lifetime. Yet we begin. In that beginning, purpose is renewed. The rest we entrust.

We step forward not because the path is certain, but because our purpose is clear. We plant what we may never see in full blossom—in small acts of listening, serving, encouraging, and giving—trusting that these seeds will take root and bear fruit in seasons beyond our own.

And so the university itself lives on—not because it possesses the truth, but because it renews the human capacities that sustain the search for truth.

And so we carry forward what endures—passing it on, as it was once passed to us, in the quiet rhythms of renewal: one curious mind, one steady heart, one light step—and the courage, always, to begin again.

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